

TOOL 2 • CAPACITY & FOCUS

The Priority Kill Switch Form

The One-In, One-Out Rule: You cannot add mass to the system without removing mass. Before a new Priority 1 initiative enters the system, an existing Priority 1 must be explicitly paused, delayed, or stopped. No hidden carryover. No unspoken expectation that the team will do both.

PART 1: THE NEW PRIORITY (WHAT ENTERS THE SYSTEM)

NEW PRIORITY 1 INITIATIVE TITLE:

TARGET COMPLETION DATE:

REQUESTING LEADER / EXECUTIVE SPONSOR:

IMPACTED DEPARTMENT(S):

WHY THIS WORK MATTERS NOW (STRATEGIC IMPERATIVE):

PART 2: THE TRADE-OFF (WHAT EXITS OR PAUSES)

CURRENT PRIORITY 1 INITIATIVE TO BE PAUSED, DELAYED, OR KILLED:

ACTION:

☐ Paused ☐ Delayed ☐ Killed

CURRENT OWNER OF THAT WORK:

NEW PROJECTED CHECKPOINT / RESTART DATE:

ACCEPTED RISK (WHAT RISK ARE WE EXPLICITLY ACCEPTING BY PAUSING THIS WORK?):

PART 3: EXECUTIVE ACCOUNTABILITY & SIGN-OFF

“By signing below, I acknowledge that the paused work will not remain an unspoken expectation for the team. I accept direct executive accountability for the risk created by this trade-off.”

Requesting Leader Signature

Executive Approver / Operations Sponsor

Name & Date

Name & Date